LING 3701/PSYCH 3371: Language & Mind

Spring 2026
W/F 11:10 - 12:30
Location: Mendenhall Lab 125

Instructor	Elena Vaikšnoraitė	**Mailbox**	Oxley 121
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Office hours	W/F 12:30-1:30pm, or by appointment	**Office hour location**	Elena's Zoom office
TA Coordinator	Dr. Hope Dawson	**Office Location**	Oxley 114
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Course modality. This course will be delivered 100% in person.

Course description and objectives. This course serves as an introduction to psycholinguistics. Psycholinguists attempt to answer four fundamental questions: What does one know when one knows a language? How do we perceive language? How do our brains decide what it is that we're hearing? How do interpret strings of sounds into meaningful sentences and conversations? How do babies learn language? How do adults learn a foreign language?

GEL Social Science: Individuals and Groups This course fulfills the OSU GEL goals in Social Science: Individuals and Groups.

Goals: Students understand the systematic study of human behavior and cognition; the structure of human societies, cultures, and institutions; and the processes by which individuals, groups, and societies interact, communicate, and use human, natural, and economic resources.

Expected Learning Outcomes:

1. Students understand the theories and methods of social scientific inquiry as they apply to the study of individuals and groups.
2. Students understand the behavior of individuals, differences and similarities in social and cultural contexts of human existence, and the processes by which groups function.
3. Students comprehend and assess individual and group values and their importance in social problem solving and policy making.

GEN Foundation: Social & Behavioral Sciences This course fulfills the OSU GEN Foundation goals in Social & Behavioral Sciences.

Goals:

1. Successful students will critically analyze and apply theoretical and empirical approaches within the social and behavioral sciences, including modern principles, theories, methods and modes of inquiry.
2. Successful students will recognize the implications of social and behavioral scientific findings and their potential impacts.

Expected Learning Outcomes:
Successful students are able to:

1.1 Explain basic facts, principles, theories and methods of social and behavioral science.

1.2 Explain and evaluate differences, similarities and disparities among institutions, organizations, cultures, societies and/or individuals using social and behavioral science.

2.1 Analyze how political, economic, individual or social factors and values impact social structures, policies and/or decisions.

2.2 Evaluate social and ethical implications of social scientific and behavioral research.

2.3 Critically evaluate and responsibly use information from the social and behavioral sciences.

Fulfillment of GEL and GEN Expected Learning Outcomes This course fulfills OSU GEL/GEN Expected Learning Outcomes by introducing students to the study of language as a psychological and cognitive phenomenon. Students will learn about linguistic analysis, experimental approaches to psycholinguistics, and the theoretical development of the field. Students will also learn about designing and conducting behavioral psycholinguistics experiments. Students are expected to understand theories of production, perception, and acquisition of language; understand cross-cultural differences and similarities in language use; and reflect on language as a social tool to inform our perspectives on human governance.

Structure of the course.

1. **Weekly readings.** Each week you will have an assigned reading. The readings are due before class. You can find the exact assigned reading on the schedule. All readings other than the textbook are provided to you on Carmen. During the class time we will walk through the key points, have a discussion and potentially group activities.
2. **Quizzes.** There will be 8 quizzes on Carmen to help make sure you're getting key points. The quizzes will be explicitly open-book and open-note. The quizzes have individual deadlines as you can see in the schedule. The quizzes are due end of day. These quizzes open a week before the deadline will remain open until one day after the deadline. So do them at your convenience. These quizzes will be graded for correctness.
3. **Midterm.** We will have a midterm in this course. It will take place before the Spring break. You are allowed to bring 1 one-sided handwritten letter paper of notes with you to the exam.
4. **Final.** We will have a final in this course during the finals week. The final is cumulative. You are allowed to bring 1 one-sided handwritten letter paper of notes with you to the exam.
5. **Homeworks.** There will be four homework assignments in the semester that ask you to think critically about some research questions. We will discuss these assignments closer to the due dates.
6. **Linguistics Outside the Classroom (LOC) Requirement.** To fulfill this requirement, you must complete 2 LOC activities through the course of the semester. To complete each activity, you may either participate in a linguistics experiment or attend a scheduled talk in the linguistics department. You will receive more detailed information in class and through Carmen.

Assessments There are 1000 points in total offered in this class. To get an A, you need to get at least 930 points. You can earn points for the following assignments.

Component	Available points (total 1000)
Linguistics Outside the Classroom (LOC)	50 (25pts x 2)
Attendance	100
Midterm	140
Final	150
Quizzes	160 (20pts x 8)
Homework	400 (100pts x 4)

Letter grade distribution The grading scheme will be following.

930 - 1000	A	730 - 769	C
900 - 929	A-	700 - 729	C-
870 - 899	B+	670 - 699	D+
830 - 869	B	600 - 669	D
800 - 829	B-	<= 599	E
770 - 799	C+		

Office hours I want you to succeed in this class and learn more about psycholinguistics, a field that I think is fascinating. If any material is unclear, don't be afraid to come forward: ask a question in the discussion forum, talk to your classmates or come (virtually) to the office hours. If you cannot make the office hours, email me and we can set up a different time that works.

Email policy I will try to respond to your emails within 24 hours during the work week (Monday-Friday). Emails received after 5pm, will not receive a response until the following morning at the earliest. Before you write an email, make sure that the answer is not on the syllabus. If you have any questions or comments about your submitted homework, please send me emails instead of leaving comments on the assignment section of Carmen, as the latter will not be regularly checked.

Announcements Since this is an in-person course, there will be a lot of in person announcements during class time. Important announcements re things like changes to deadlines, syllabus, class cancelations etc will also be announced via Carmen, so make sure you get the notifications.

Attendance policy In this course we will cover a lot of material, and it will not be to your advantage to miss class. However, if you do the assigned reading and ask me or your colleagues clarification questions you should be fine. If you are not able to attend class regularly, reach out to Student Life Disability Services now. To encourage attendance, I will take formal attendance. Each month you will receive a grade. Attendance points will come from you attending the class. Each of you have **4** excused absences per semester, i.e. missing 4 classes in total will not affect your participation grade. You can use these absences for illnesses, to see doctors, attend family events, take a mental health days, etc. Please let me know earlier or up to 48 after missing the class that you want to use an excused absence. All absences after 4 excused absences will impact your grade (barring hospitalization). To earn participation points for a given class session, you must attend the class. You can get brownie points for very active engagement in the classroom either during class or before/after the class, ie. by asking/answering questions.

Collaboration For all components of the course, collaboration is prohibited and constitutes academic misconduct.

Use of AI in this course Given that the learning goals of this class are developing your ability to read, summarize scientific findings as well as develop your own research, the use of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools such as Copilot or ChatGPT, writers aids like Grammarly, or translation platforms such as Google Translate is **not** permitted in this course. Any use of GenAI tools for work in this class may therefore be considered a violation of Ohio State's Academic Integrity policy and Code of Student Conduct because the work is not your own. If I suspect that you have used GenAI on an assignment for this course, I will ask you to explain your process for completing the assignment in question. The unauthorized use of GenAI tools will result in referral to the Committee on Academic Misconduct.

Late work All assignments are due at midnight on Carmen. All assignments are open a week before deadline, which means you have a week to complete each assignment. Late work is accepted up to 24 hours after the deadline without a penalty. No assignment will be accepted later than that.

Required materials

- **The textbook**: Julie Sedivy. 2014/2019. *Language in Mind: An Introduction to Psycholinguistics*, Sinauer Associations.

  Note: There are two editions. I will be using the new edition of this textbook (2019) but the older edition is also fine.

- **Scientific articles**: all articles will be made available on Carmen

Course website All materials, assignments etc will be published on Carmen. You will need to use BuckeyePass (buckeyepass.osu.edu) multi-factor authentication to access your courses in Carmen. To ensure that you are able to connect to Carmen at all times, it is recommended that you take the following steps:

- Register multiple devices in case something happens to your primary device. Visit the BuckeyePass - Adding a Device help article for step-by-step instructions (go.osu.edu/add-device).
- Request passcodes to keep as a backup authentication option. When you see the Duo login screen on your computer, click Enter a Passcode and then click the Text me new codes button that appears. This will text you ten passcodes good for 365 days that can each be used once.
- Download the Duo Mobile application (go.osu.edu/install-duo) to all of your registered devices for the ability to generate one-time codes in the event that you lose cell, data, or Wi-Fi service

Technology support For help with your password, university email, Carmen, or any other technology issues, questions, or requests, contact the Ohio State IT Service Desk. Support for urgent issues is available 24/7.

Self-Service and Chat support: ocio.osu.edu/help
Phone: 614-688-4357(HELP)
Email: servicedesk@osu.edu
TDD: 614-688-8743

University wide policies

- **Academic Misconduct** Your assignments should be your own original work. In written assignments, you should follow APA style to cite the ideas and words of your sources. You are welcome to ask a trusted person to proofread your assignments before you turn them in, but no one else should revise or rewrite your work.

  It is the responsibility of the Committee on Academic Misconduct to investigate or establish procedures for the investigation of all reported cases of student academic misconduct. The term "academic misconduct" includes all forms of student academic misconduct wherever committed; illustrated by, but not limited to, cases of plagiarism and dishonest practices in connection with examinations. Instructors shall report all instances of alleged academic misconduct to the committee (Faculty Rule 3335-5-487). For additional information, see the Code of Student Conduct http://studentlife.osu.edu/csc/

  If you have any questions about the above policy or what constitutes academic misconduct in this course, please contact me.

  Some forms of academic misconduct include but are not limited to:

  1. copying from another student's assignment
  2. allowing another student to copy from your assignment
  3. providing or receiving information during exams
  4. copying text from the Internet or a book without saying where it is from
  5. paraphrasing someone else's ideas and pretending they are your own

- **Artificial Intelligence and Academic Integrity** There has been a significant increase in the popularity and availability of a variety of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools, including ChatGPT, Sudowrite and others. These tools will help shape the future of work, research and technology but when used in the wrong way, they can stand in conflict with academic integrity at Ohio State.

  All students have important obligations under the Code of Student Conduct to complete all academic and scholarly activities with fairness and honesty. Our professional students also have the responsibility to uphold the professional and ethical standards found in their respective academic honor codes. Specifically, students are not to use unauthorized assistance in the laboratory, on field work, in scholarship or on a course assignment unless such assistance has been authorized specifically by the course instructor. In addition, students are not to submit their work without acknowledging any word-for-word use and/or paraphrasing of writing, ideas or other work that is not your own. These requirements apply to all students undergraduate, graduate, and professional.

- **Health and safety requirements** Reminder: All teaching staff and students are required to comply with university safety and health guidance. Review guidelines at Safe and Healthy Buckeyes (`https://safeandhealthy.osu.edu/`).

- **Students with Disabilities** The university strives to maintain a healthy and accessible environment to support student learning in and out of the classroom. If you anticipate or experience academic barriers based on

your disability (including mental health, chronic, or temporary medical conditions), please let me know immediately so that we can privately discuss options. To establish reasonable accommodations, I may request that you register with Student Life Disability Services. After registration, make arrangements with me as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so that they may be implemented in a timely fashion.

If you are ill and need to miss class, including if you are staying home and away from others while experiencing symptoms of a viral infection or fever, please let me know immediately. In cases where illness interacts with an underlying medical condition, please consult with Student Life Disability Services to request reasonable accommodations. You can connect with them at slds@osu.edu; 614-292-3307; or slds.osu.edu.

- **Intellectual Diversity** Ohio State is committed to fostering a culture of open inquiry and intellectual diversity within the classroom. This course will cover a range of information and may include discussions or debates about controversial issues, beliefs, or policies. Any such discussions and debates are intended to support understanding of the approved curriculum and relevant course objectives rather than promote any specific point of view. Students will be assessed on principles applicable to the field of study and the content covered in the course. Preparing students for citizenship includes helping them develop critical thinking skills that will allow them to reach their own conclusions regarding complex or controversial matters.

- **Religious accommodations**

  Ohio State has had a longstanding practice of making reasonable academic accommodations for students' religious beliefs and practices in accordance with applicable law. In 2023, Ohio State updated its practice to align with new state legislation. Under this new provision, students must be in early communication with their instructors regarding any known accommodation requests for religious beliefs and practices, providing notice of specific dates for which they request alternative accommodations within 14 days after the first instructional day of the course. Instructors in turn shall not question the sincerity of a student's religious or spiritual belief system in reviewing such requests and shall keep requests for accommodations confidential.

  With sufficient notice, instructors will provide students with reasonable alternative accommodations with regard to examinations and other academic requirements with respect to students' sincerely held religious beliefs and practices by allowing up to three absences each semester for the student to attend or participate in religious activities. Examples of religious accommodations can include, but are not limited to, rescheduling an exam, altering the time of a student's presentation, allowing make-up assignments to substitute for missed class work, or flexibility in due dates or research responsibilities. If concerns arise about a requested accommodation, instructors are to consult their tenure initiating unit head for assistance.

  A student's request for time off shall be provided if the student's sincerely held religious belief or practice severely affects the student's ability to take an exam or meet an academic requirement and the student has notified their instructor, in writing during the first 14 days

after the course begins, of the date of each absence. Although students are required to provide notice within the first 14 days after a course begins, instructors are strongly encouraged to work with the student to provide a reasonable accommodation if a request is made outside the notice period. A student may not be penalized for an absence approved under this policy.

If students have questions or disputes related to academic accommodations, they should contact their course instructor, and then their department or college office. For questions or to report discrimination or harassment based on religion, individuals should contact the Civil Rights Compliance Office. (Policy: Religious Holidays, Holy Days and Observances.)

- **Weather or other short-term closing** Should in-person classes be canceled, I will notify you as to which alternative methods of teaching will be offered to ensure continuity of instruction for this class. I will share any updates via CarmenCanvas.

Course Technology For help with your password, university e-mail, Carmen, or any other technology issues, questions, or requests, contact the OSU IT Service Desk. Standard support hours are available at https://ocio.osu.edu/help/hours, and support for urgent issues is available 24x7.

Carmen Carmen, Ohio State's Learning Management System, will be used to host materials and activities throughout this course. To access Carmen, visit `Carmen.osu.edu`. Log in to Carmen using your name.# and password. If you have not setup a name.# and password, visit `my.osu.edu`. Help guides on the use of Carmen can be found at `https://resourcecenter.odee.osu.edu/carmen` Self-Service and Chat support: `http://ocio.osu.edu/selfservice` Phone: 614-688-HELP (4357) Email: 8help@osu.edu TDD: 614-688-8743 Necessary software Word processor with the ability to save files under .doc, .docx, .rtf, or .pdf. Most popular word processing software programs including Microsoft Word and Mac Pages have these abilities. OSU students have access to Microsoft Office products free of charge. To install, please visit `https://osuitsm.service-now.com/selfservice/kb_view.do?s`

The Writing Center - `https://cstw.osu.edu/our-programs/writing-center` The Writing Center offers free help with writing at any stage of the writing process for any member of the university community. During sessions, consultants can work with you on anything from research papers to lab reports, from dissertations to résumés, from proposals to application materials. You may schedule an appointment by visiting WCOnline or by calling 614-688-4291. You do not have to bring in a piece of writing in order to schedule a writing center appointment. Many students report that some of their most productive sessions entail simply talking through ideas. Please check out Individual Writing Support and Group Writing Support pages for the types of consultations provided. They also maintain a Writing Resources page with writing handouts and links to online resources.

Mental Health As a student you may experience a range of issues that can cause barriers to learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, alcohol/drug problems, feeling down, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may lead to diminished academic performance or reduce a student's ability to participate in daily activities. The Ohio State University offers services to assist you with addressing these and other concerns you may be experiencing. If you or someone you know are suffering from any of the aforementioned conditions, you can learn more about the broad range of confidential mental health services available on campus via the Office of Student Life's Counseling and Consultation Service

(CCS) by visiting ccs.osu.edu or calling 614-292-5766. CCS is located on the 4th Floor of the Younkin Success Center and 10th Floor of Lincoln Tower. You can reach an on call counselor when CCS is closed at 614-292-5766 and 24 hour emergency help is also available 24/7 by dialing 988 to reach the Suicide and Crisis Lifeline.

Dennis Learning Center `http://dennislearningcenter.osu.edu/` The DLC applies their expertise in education, psychology, instruction, and technology to provide outreach that includes elective courses, workshops, and individual academic coaching. They help students flourish by providing assistance in areas that include motivation, academic stress, procrastination, study skills, time management, test taking, learning from text, note taking, and self-regulation.

APA Citation and Style Guides `https://www.apastyle.org/index`
`https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/gene`

SMART Lab - `https://u.osu.edu/smartlab/schedule/` Our mission in the SMART Lab is to teach and research the efficacy of stress management and resiliency skills with students at Ohio State. (They offer both online and in person services including group meditation, guided mindfulness and biofeedback.)

Course Schedule. The schedule is subject to change. Changes will be announced via Carmen. All classes will have at most one required reading. S = Sevidy's textbook.

Week	Date	Topic	Reading	Due
1	1/14 (W)	Language and Linguistics		
	1/16 (F)	Origins of language	S 2.1-2.3	
2	1/21 (W)			
	1/23 (F)	Neural basis of language	S 3.1-3.2	
3	1/28 (W)		S 3.3-3.4	Quiz 1
	1/30 (F)	Sound acquisition	S 4.1-4.2	
4	2/4 (W)		S 4.3-4.5	
	2/6 (F)	Markedness	Berent et al (2007)	Quiz 2
5	2/11 (W)			Homework 1
	2/13 (F)	Word acquisition	S 5.1-5.3	
6	2/18 (W)		S 5.4-5.6	
	2/20 (F)	Structure of Sentences	S 6.1-6.2	Quiz 3
7	2/25 (W)		S 6.3 -6.5	
	2/27 (F)	Syntactic ambiguity	Arnold et al (2004)	Quiz 4
8	3/4 (W)	Midterm prep		Homework 2
	3/6 (F)	**Midterm**		LOC1
9	3/11 (W)	Speech perception	S 7.1-7.2	
	3/13 (F)		S 7.3-7.4	Quiz 5
10	3/25 (W)	Word recognition	S 8.1-8.2	
	3/27 (F)		S 8.3-8.4	Homework 3
11	4/1 (W)	Models of word recognition	Magnuson et al 2007	Quiz 6
	4/3 (F)	Sentence processing	S 9.1-9.2	
12	4/8 (W)		S 9.3-9.5	Quiz 7
	4/10 (F)	Discourse and Inference	S 11.1-11.2	
13	4/15 (W)		S 11.3-11.4	
	4/17 (F)	Anaphora resolution	Arnold et al (2007)	
14	4/22 (W)	Bilingualism		Homework 4
	4/24 (F)	Final prep		Quiz 8, LOC2
	4/29 (W)	**Final 12:00pm-1:45pm**		